THE STRANGE CASE OF DR JEKYLL AND MR HYDE
by Robert Louis Stevenson
(B1+–B2+)

INTRODUCTION

Ss read an extract from *The Strange Case of Dr Jekyll and Mr Hyde* by Robert Louis Stevenson in which Dr Henry Jekyll describes turning into Mr Hyde. Then they listen to an extract continuing the story in which Dr Jekyll describes how he feels as Mr Hyde. Ss find out about words that come from literature and talk about scientific discoveries.

Supplementary Materials

WARM UP: pictures sourced online or from the science department in your school for the classification of chemicals, i.e. red diamonds warning that a chemical is corrosive, flammable, toxic, explosive, an irritant, etc.

ACTIVE INVESTIGATION: internet access; a big Italian-English dictionary (not a learners' dictionary as the words are not all common enough even for an Advanced dictionary).

CLIL CONNECTION: internet access OR encyclopedias

Culture notes

Robert Louis Stevenson
Robert Louis Stevenson was a poet, a travel writer and a novelist. Though he started training as an engineer and then as a lawyer, he was always interested in writing and at the age of twenty-five, began to devote his life to literature. He was a sickly child who had to spend most of the winters in bed and his longing for adventure and travel may be partly accounted for by his search for a cure for his illness. At various times in his life, he lived in France, the United States and in the South Seas, where he became known as 'The Teller of Stories'. The immediate success of his adventure story, *Treasure Island* (1883), and of *The Strange Case of Dr Jekyll and Mr Hyde* (1886), made him famous, and he followed them with a series of historical novels about Scotland. Stevenson died, aged only 44, in 1894 in Samoa. For a long time, Stevenson was considered a popular novelist but not to be taken seriously as literature. More recently however he has become part of literary studies.

The Strange Case of Dr Jekyll and Mr Hyde
Dr Jekyll's experiments with potions to transform himself into a man with no conscience who does terrible things and, eventually, takes over the doctor completely. The story is told from the point of view of Dr Jekyll's lawyer with the final answers delivered via a letter Doctor Jekyll has written in case he disappears forever. The phrase 'Jekyll and Hyde' has entered common speech to mean someone who seems to have a split personality and can act very sweetly and then suddenly turn mean and nasty.

WARM UP

Show Ss the chemical symbols (see Supplementary materials) and see if anyone can guess their meanings. Ask *Is it safe to drink any of these chemicals?* (No)

PREPARATION

THINKING ROUTINE

1

see

Focus Ss on the Yin Yang symbol. Ask *What does this picture represent?*

ANSWERS:
1 The balance of good and bad

think, wonder

Focus on the questions and allow time for Ss to discuss in pairs. Monitor and help with vocabulary as needed, making note of anything useful on the board. For feedback, elicit answers as a class.

ANSWERS:
think
2 Ss' own answers
3 Possible answers: fear of getting caught; fear of God and eternal punishment; fear of what people might think of them; fear of the law and going to prison; simply knowing right from wrong and not wanting to hurt people, i.e. moral code and conscience.

wonder
4 Ss' own answers

PHOTOCOPIABLE © Pearson Education Limited 2022

COMPREHENSION

READING PREVIEW

Focus Ss on the title and draw two columns on the board and label them 'Dr Jekyll' and 'Mr Hyde'. Tell Ss they're going to find out more about these two people and that Dr Jekyll is the narrator of this part of the story. Ask *What does he mean 'I become Mr Hyde'?* Ss may guess that he changes into someone else or may be confused or intrigued, but don't confirm any guesses at this stage.

READING EXTRACT LL9.01

Tell Ss they are going to read an extract from *The Strange Case of Dr Jekyll and Mr Hyde* about a doctor who changes himself in a

horrible, unimaginable way. Allow time for them to read in silence, or play the recording while they read. If you're going to play the recording, focus on the glossary words in the box first so Ss will understand them when they listen and read.

When they have finished, elicit anything we can learn about Dr Jekyll and write it under the appropriate column. (He's a scientist; wants to change his body; is curious; can be brave; is perhaps tall as he says he loses height.)

Establish that, through the drugs he has taken, he has become a different person: Mr Hyde. Again, elicit anything we can know of Mr Hyde (shorter than Dr Jekyll; he is enjoying the feelings and the feelings are evil, therefore he is a bad person).

Ask *If we know Mr Hyde is a bad person, does that mean Dr Jekyll is/ was a good man?* (If Ss have understood the idea that both men are two sides of one man, Dr Jekyll, then they may think Dr Jekyll is a bad man as this is part of him. Or, they may see it more like two completely separate people, changed by the drugs and that Jekyll is the opposite of Hyde. There is no strictly correct answer here

as it is part of a wider idea about good and evil and humans' true nature.)

2 Focus on the questions and tell Ss their answers can be 1–3 words long and they do not need to write full sentences. Allow time for them to complete the questions individually and then compare with a partner.

Check answers as a class and encourage Ss to go back to the text to justify their answers, especially in the case of wrong answers so they can work out where they went wrong.

ANSWERS:

1 death
2 salt
3 pain/sickness/illness
4 younger/lighter/happier
5 pleased
6 He was shorter./He lost height.

LISTENING

3 LL9.02 Focus on the question and tell Ss they are going to listen to what Dr Jekyll thinks about being Mr Hyde. Play the recording once or twice for Ss to make notes. Check the answer as a class.

Return to the question you asked before about whether Dr Jekyll was a good man and see if Ss have changed their mind or added to their ideas. (It may confirm the idea that Jekyll is a bad man as he seems to be very excited about being able to indulge himself in doing whatever he wants and not getting caught.)

ANSWERS:

Commit crimes and not get caught.

LL9.02 AUDIOSCRIPT

Men have, before now, hired others to do their crimes for them. I was the first that ever did so just for pleasure. I was the first who could appear respectable in the eyes of the public. But I could, in a moment, like a schoolboy, throw off the clothes of **respectability** and jump head first into the sea of freedom. In

my **unrecognisable** mask, I was completely safe. Think of it, I did not even exist! Just let me escape into my laboratory … just give me a second or two to mix and swallow the drugs … and Edward Hyde, whatever he had done, would disappear like a breath on

a mirror. And there instead, quietly at home … working late at night in his study, would be Henry Jekyll … a man who could afford to laugh at any suspicion.

ACTIVE INVESTIGATION

4A Tell Ss that the phrase 'to be a Jekyll and Hyde character' has become part of the English language. Ask *What do you think it means?*

ANSWERS:

Someone who often changes personality and behaviour from good to bad and back again.

B Say literature has given us other new words, both in English and Italian. Focus Ss on the list of words and see which ones they know the meanings of. They may want to translate them into Italian first, using the dictionaries. See if they can tell you which literary works the words come from. Then allow time for Ss to research the answers online, either at home or in class. Check answers as a class.

PHOTOCOPIABLE © Pearson Education Limited 2022

ANSWERS:

1 quixotic = donchisciottesco, *Don Quixote de la Mancha* by Miguel de Cervantes, idealistic and impractical, with big ideas that are too impractical to achieve.

2 utopia = le utopia, *Utopia* by Sir Thomas More, an ideal and perfect version of the world.

3 pandemonium = il pandemonio, *Paradise Lost* by Milton, absolute chaos.

4 mentor = il mentore, *The Odyssey* by Homer, someone who offers advice and support.

5 robot = i robot, *R.U.R.* (*Rossum's Universal Robots*) by Karel Čapek (though it was his brother, Josef, who coined the word), a machine that can do jobs for humans.

CLIL CONNECTION

Science

5 **Explain that Dr Jekyll makes a scientific discovery and he chooses to use science for evil. Ask *What other big scientific discoveries can be used for bad things?* Elicit any ideas Ss have. Then focus Ss on the three discoveries in the Students' Book and allow time for them to research, online or in the encyclopedias (see Supplementary materials), the names of the scientists and the dates of the discoveries. Check answers as a class.**

ANSWERS:

These discoveries are built up from the works of many people over time so the below are some of the main contributors. Ss may research in more detail.

1 Paul Ehrlich discovered that the chemical arsphenamine could kill certain bacteria (syphilis), 1909. Alexander Fleming, 1928, accidentally discovered penicillin. Selman Waksman first used the word 'antibiotics' and he discovered over 20 antibiotics in the late 1930s–1940s.

2 Norbert Wiener came up with the idea of feedback mechanisms in the 1940s. Newell and Simon, 1955, developed the first AI program. John McCarthy, 1956, known as the father of AI as he coined the name.

3 Early 1900s, Ernest Rutherford is called the father of nuclear physics. James Chadwick's discovery of the neutron in 1932. Enrico Fermi's work on chain reactions in 1939–1942.

SPEAKING

6 **Divide Ss into pairs to discuss the benefits and drawbacks to each of the three discoveries and how they are used. Monitor and help with vocabulary as needed.**

ANSWERS:

Ss' own answers. The following are brief suggestions for direction only.

a) Improve health and people live longer but people become resistant and super bacteria develop. Improved health leads to overpopulation.

b) Enable humans to pursue higher goals and achieve more, but machines could destroy us.

c) Energy that's more sustainable because it reduces the burning of fossil fuels for energy, but it is the doorway to the possible end of mankind and civilisation through nuclear war.

Alternative approach

Assign pairs of Ss one side of the argument and stage three debates about the benefits and drawbacks to each of these discoveries and how they are used.

Homework ideas

- Ss write an essay about the dangers and benefits of the scientific discoveries based on their ideas in CLIL Connection, Question 2.
- Ss write their own description of drinking a potion that will change them somehow, how they would be different and what they would do.

PHOTOCOPIABLE © Pearson Education Limited 2022